

TWO FOLDERS · THE ART LAYER · WHAT CHANGED AND WHY

1 · You now have two copies of the project. Pick one tonight.

Folder	State
C:\Users\anike\Hackforgersc2c	The clone. Use this one. Real clone tracking main, outside OneDrive, and it has the newer work including art.js.
...	
\OneDrive\Desktop\Code2Create26\working-prototype-v1	The original. Same content minus art.js. Inside OneDrive, which is what causes the random .git/index.lock errors.

Do this now: rename the old one to working-prototype-v1-OLD. Don't delete it — just make it impossible to open by accident at 4 AM and lose an hour wondering why your change didn't appear. Everything from here happens in the clone, and tell the other four the same thing.

2 · Everything still passes the standing rules

- | | |
|--------------------------------|--|
| 1. no external resources | PASS - nothing loaded from the network |
| 2. no npm / build / framework | PASS - no package.json, no node_modules |
| 3. no image or audio files | PASS - every pixel is drawn in code |
| 4. rule IDs match the contract | PASS - all 8 consistent across evidence, levels, panel |
| 6. no web fonts | PASS - system font stack only |

All ten JS files parse clean. Both themes render. Nothing regressed, and whoever wrote art.js kept the comment voice — *"that one line is what makes a ledge readable at a glance in either theme"* is a real sentence, not a generated one.

3 · What art.js actually did — and why it's the right shape

483 lines, 22 functions, and it took the game from three grey slabs to a meadow and a lava cavern. That's the biggest single visual jump the project has had, and UI/UX is a scored criterion.

The architecture is the part worth defending. Every paint function takes coordinates and draws. **None of them read or write game state.** So the project now has four layers that can each change without the other three noticing:

levels.js	WHERE things are	(data)
rules.js	HOW physics behaves	(the secret)
art.js	WHAT it looks like	(theme)
engine.js	asks all three, every frame	

That's why one arena can be a meadow and the next a cavern with no engine change, and why the same arena can run any of eight rules. **Say exactly that when someone asks what's technically interesting.** It's true, it's specific, and it's unusual for a 48-hour build.

Two themes share one piece of grammar — *every surface you can stand on gets a bright yellow-green lip*. That's a genuinely good design decision. It means a ledge is readable in a bright field or a black cave without the player relearning anything.

4 · Three problems with it, in order of how much they matter

a) It reads as Super Mario, and that's a real risk

The green pipe, the cloud shapes, the brown-earth-under-green-grass band and the door — together they're unmistakably Super Mario Bros. Individually each is generic; combined they're a specific game.

Why it matters here: a judge who plays games will clock it in two seconds, and the whole pitch rests on "*nobody has made this before*." Looking borrowed undercuts the one claim you can't afford to weaken. **Fix:** keep the palette, the lip grammar and the craft — change the **pipe** to something that isn't a pipe (a stone plinth, a broken column) and the **clouds** to a different silhouette. Twenty minutes, and it stops being a comparison anyone makes out loud.

b) The per-attempt colour shift is gone

We decided at H3 that the world takes a random *neutral tint each attempt* — so the player feels "something shifted" without being told what. The theme is now fixed **per level**, so that signal has quietly disappeared. It's in DECISIONS.md as a decision we made and no longer do.

Fix, and it's small: keep the theme, and paint one translucent tint over the whole frame per attempt — pick from the six neutrals, redraw on N. Ten lines in draw(). The meadow stays a meadow, it just shifts mood between attempts, and the "reality moved" beat comes back.

c) The player is no longer the loudest thing on screen

The backdrop is now more detailed than the character. In the meadow the yellow box sits next to a pipe of similar size and reads as scenery. The play area is also a thin band across the bottom third while sky fills the top — beautiful, but the game happens in a letterbox.

Fix: give the player a dark outline and a soft shadow so it separates from any backdrop, and dim the sky slightly. **Test it the honest way:** stand two metres back. If your eye doesn't land on the player first, the backdrop is winning.

5 · Figma

The link exists and that's what the reviewers asked for, so you're covered. I couldn't read the file directly — Figma's Dev Mode server isn't switched on. If you want me to work from the designs: **Figma menu → Preferences → Enable Dev Mode MCP Server**, then restart the Claude desktop app. **Not tonight.** It's 02:15 and this is worth nothing before the demo works.

What Anvita should put in it, in priority order: the **twelve storyboard frames** (transcription, not design), the **palette** with the two-line note about colour being redundant, and **arena layouts to scale**. Sections 1 and 3 alone answer what a reviewer opens a Figma link to find out: *did they design before they built?*

6 · Where the project actually stands

Piece	State
The loop	Complete. Experiment → notice → call → scored on the gap.
Rules live in the engine	5 of 8 — normal, reverse gravity, inverted controls, no jumping, momentum

Rules in logic only	3 — bullets push, shifting platforms, movement costs time
Arenas	6 , all validated, two themes
Call panel	Done. All 8 always pickable, optional hints on H
Scoring	Done, with the correct/wrong screens
Run history	Done — leaderboard-shaped, one player so far
Simulator	Done — 16,000 attempts, median 3 moves
Earliest-evidence replay	Not built. The data is being logged for it.
Playtest data	None yet. The build works now, so this is possible.

7 • What to do next, in order

1. **Rename the old folder.** Two minutes. Prevents the worst kind of 4 AM confusion.
2. **Commit and push from the clone.** Nothing since the art landed is on GitHub.
3. **The Mario fix** — pipe and clouds. Twenty minutes, and it protects the pitch.
4. **The per-attempt tint back.** Ten lines, restores a decision we already argued for.
5. **Player readability** — outline and shadow.
6. **Playtesting.** The build is genuinely playable now. Anvita has the sheet. **Ten people before you sleep is worth more than a sixth rule** — nobody else in that hall will have measured real players, and for a game about how people reason, that data *is* the subject.
7. Then the replay, then the remaining three rules.

One thing to be pleased about

At hour 0 you had five people, two of whom had never programmed, and an empty folder. At hour 11 there's a working game with eight rules in a validated table, six arenas, two art themes, a scoring system nobody can luck their way through, and sixteen thousand simulated runs proving it's solvable. The reason it fits together is that the names were frozen before anyone wrote code. Keep doing that.